

version of the latest iOS but for older generation devices which are no longer supported.

So if you have an iPod Touch 1st gen or 2nd gen which are limited to iOS 3.1.3 and 4.2.1 or iPhone 1st gen / 2nd gen then installing Whited00r on your device gets you features of iOS 5. Be it simple things like the new ringtones that come in iOS 5 or useful features like multitasking where the background apps are still running and not paused when you switch between applications. This project is not just limited to older gen apple devices, red00r, a variant of Whited00r based on iOS 4 is still under development. Also, the folks who came out with whited00r have recently released the first beta of yel-lowd00r which brings OS X Lion to 3rd/4th Generation macs.

Lesser known firmware for lesser known devices

There are various tools available on the internet for modifying the firmware of lesser known devices. All you have to figure out is whether your device is based on the same SOC chip as they tool.

There is the Rockchip UI Editor for all PMPs based on the Rockchip RK27 and there is a tool for Gemei's HD8800 chip. Most of these devices are termed as knock-offs of more popular brands, however, once laden with custom firmware, these devices are as good as if not better than the real thing.

Given the fact that these are cheap SOC's major brands often have android devices powered by these chips which brings out the aspect of having android onto these players. However, companies don't bring out these products with Android on them as the licensing fees would raise the price and subsequently hurt sales. Hence, they take the easy way out by developing their own firmware in-house. Android can then be ported onto these devices provided the hardware is good enough.

Conclusion

There are plenty of options in the market that you can go in for. Various brands like Cowon, Apple, Archos, iriver, MPIO, Onda, Olympus etc. offer a variety of PMPs, however, like all major brands, these products are segregated into various categories based on price and often they share the same hardware across various price brackets, all that makes them different are the goodies that they come with and the firmware. So can you buy a budget-friendly PMP and make it sound like one of the more expensive ones? Well, to a certain extent, yes.